What to Do When You Win the USAID DIV Fund: The Complete Technical, Financial, and Operational Roadmap (Start-to-Finish)

AgroBiometrix Implementation Protocol: A 24-Month Master Execution Plan from Award Negotiation to DIV Stage 2 ($1.5M) Scale-Up

***Award Mechanism**: USAID DIV Stage 1 Proof of Concept ($150,000 / 24 Months) • **Target Beneficiaries**: 10,000+ Smallholders*
***Lead Implementing Organization**: AgroBiometrix Engineering Unit / Naysa-84 Labs in consortium with FUNAAB, OOU, FPI, and UGA*
***Principal Investigator / Project Director**: Dr. Young Imienwain Irivboje (FUNAAB / Naysa-84)*

EXECUTIVE MANDATE: TURNING $150K SEED EVIDENCE INTO A $1.5M SCALING ENGINE

The Fundamental Philosophy of USAID DIV: Winning a USAID DIV grant is fundamentally different from receiving traditional donor aid or charity. DIV operates as an **evidence-driven venture fund** within the US Government. USAID is investing $150,000 into AgroBiometrix to answer one critical question: *'Can an Africa-first, sovereign biometrical operating system with last-mile vernacular voice dissemination produce statistically verified yield and revenue gains among smallholders at a dramatically lower unit cost than traditional extension?'*
If you prove this with gold-standard causal evidence (Difference-in-Differences), rigorous unit economics ($0.02 radio / $0.20 voice robocall), and operational fidelity, AgroBiometrix unlocks the gateway to **USAID DIV Stage 2 ($1,500,000)** and nationwide government adoption. This document defines your exact roadmap from Day 1 to Month 24.

Phase 0: Pre-Award Due Diligence & Negotiation (Months -2 to 0 / Post-Notification)

Upon receiving notification of selection from the DIV Agreement Officer (AO), the formal negotiation and pre-award compliance phase commences. This phase typically spans 60 to 90 days before initial funds are disbursed.

Key Action Items & Requirements:

- **SAM.gov & Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) Validation**: Ensure active registration on the US Government System for Award Management (SAM.gov). Naysa-84 / AgroBiometrix must maintain valid NCAGE and UEI codes.
- **Non-US Organization Pre-Award Survey (NUPAS) / Financial Risk Review**: USAID will evaluate your internal financial management, segregation of duties, procurement policies, and anti-fraud protocols.
- **Award Mechanism Selection (Fixed Amount Award vs. Cooperative Agreement)**: Stage 1 DIV awards are predominantly structured as **Fixed Amount Awards (FAAs)**. Under an FAA, disbursements are *milestone-based* rather than reimbursement-based. You are paid tranches upon verification of delivered milestones (e.g., approved MEL plan, baseline completed, vernacular audio engine deployed).
- **Designated Bank Account Establishment**: Open a segregated, dedicated institutional bank account (USD and local currency NGN) exclusively for USAID project funds. Never commingle grant funds with personal or general organizational capital.
- **Assignment of Key Personnel & Agreement Officer Representative (AOR)**: Finalize the formal designation of Dr. Young Irivboje as PI / Project Director and establish weekly communication protocols with your assigned USAID AOR in Washington.

Phase 1 to 5: The 24-Month Chronological Execution Lifecycle

The project execution is organized into five structured phases across two full agricultural cropping cycles (Wet and Dry seasons):

Timeline	Phase & Focus	Core Technical & Operational Deliverables	Disbursement Trigger
Months 1–4 Phase 1	**Inception, Governance & Baseline Survey**	• AOR Kickoff Conference & Approval of Year 1 Work Plan. • Finalize Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning (MEL) Plan. • Secure Institutional Review Board (IRB) ethical clearance (FUNAAB). • Register Pre-Analysis Plan (PAP) on AEA / OSF Registry. • Deploy digital enumerators (ODK/Kobo); complete Baseline Survey of N=3,000 smallholders across 30 agrarian clusters.	**Milestone 1** Approved MEL Plan + IRB Clearance + Baseline Dataset ($35,000)

Months 5–8 Phase 2	**Technical Engineering & Broadcast Setup**	• Production deployment of Suite 8: Last-Mile Vernacular Radio Engine. • Integrate Africa's Talking API for 2G GSM cellular voice robocalls. • Onboard 10–15 rural community FM radio stations (ZaraRadio/Rivendell automated RSS podcast polling). • Ingest NARS soil acidity titration & SAMMAZ maize trial datasets. • Complete colloquial translation & voice QA (Hausa, Yoruba, Swahili, French).	**Milestone 2** Verified Telephony & Radio Pipeline + Station MoUs ($30,000)
Months 9–14 Phase 3A	**Season 1 Rollout (Major Wet Season)**	• Launch dawn/dusk FM radio advisories (lime neutralization + SAMMAZ-15 seed). • Dispatch targeted 2G GSM voice robocalls to 1,500 treatment smallholders. • Real-time telemetry monitoring (call completions, radio transmission logs). • Mid-season crop health monitoring & Fall Armyworm alert broadcast. • Quarterly Progress Report (QPR 1 & 2) submitted to USAID AOR.	**Milestone 3** Season 1 Broadcast Logs + 10k Farmer Reach Audit ($30,000)
Months 15–18 Phase 3B	**Season 2 Rollout (Minor Wet / Dry Season)**	• Deploy dry-season irrigation advisory via FAO-56 Penman-Monteith (ET0). • Broadcast hermetic storage post-harvest alerts & livestock THI heat stress. • Conduct intermediate pulse surveys to measure input purchase and lime adoption. • Annual Review Conference with USAID DIV team; submit Annual Report.	**Milestone 4** Annual Performance Report + Season 2 Deployment ($25,000)
Months 19–21 Phase 4	**Endline Survey & DiD Econometric Analysis**	• Execute Endline Survey of all 3,000 farming households (target attrition < 5%). • Estimate causal treatment effect (δ) via Difference-in-Differences (DiD). • Calculate verified Benefit-Cost Ratio (BCR) and cost-per-farmer-contact. • Draft publication-grade evaluation manuscript for academic journal submission.	**Milestone 5** Econometric Evaluation Report + Clean Datasets ($20,000)
Months 22–24 Phase 5	**Closeout, Dissemination & Stage 2 Preparation**	• Host National Policy Dissemination Workshop in Abuja with FMAFS and NARS. • Upload de-identified datasets to USAID Development Data Library (DDL). • Publish technical evaluation on USAID Development Experience Clearinghouse (DEC). • Final Performance Report (FPR) and financial audit sign-off. • **Submit USAID DIV Stage 2 Application ($1,500,000 Scaling Grant)**.	**Milestone 6** Final Closeout Report + DEC/DDL Submission ($10,000)

Detailed $150,000 Budget Allocation Across the 24-Month Grant

Every dollar of the $150,000 grant must be strategically allocated across technical engineering, field evaluation rigor, last-mile voice delivery, and compliance governance:

Budget Category & Line Item	Allocation ($)	% Total	Strategic Operational Justification & Description
1. Personnel & Scientific Leadership • Principal Investigator / PI (Dr. Young Irivboje) - 25% LOE • Co-Investigators (Agronomy, Economics, Breeding) • Full-Stack Cloud/Telephony AI Software Engineer (pt)	**$42,000**	**28.0%**	Covers key personnel Level of Effort (LOE) to direct operations, supervise multi-agent engineering, ensure biometrical rigor, oversee field enumerators, and lead econometric modeling across the 24-month grant period.

2. Field Surveys & Impact Evaluation • Baseline Survey (N=3,000 households, 30 clusters) • Endline Survey (N=3,000 households with tracking) • 20 Agricultural Enumerator Stipends & Training • Field Supervisors, Tablets, Mobile Data & ODK setup	**$45,000**	**30.0%**	The core evidence engine of Stage 1. Covers enumerator training, field logistics, household surveys, GPS mapping of trial clusters, farmer respondent time compensations, and data quality audits.
3. Telephony, Voice & Vernacular Audio Engine • Africa's Talking Outbound 2G GSM Voice Airtime • 10–15 Community FM Radio Partnership Broadcast MoUs • Vernacular Voice Recording, Dialect QA & Studio Fees • Cloud Storage & Automated RFC 2.0 RSS Hosting	**$28,000**	**18.7%**	Funds ~60,000–80,000 outbound cellular voice robocall minutes to smallholder basic feature phones, dawn/dusk broadcast slot partnerships with 10–15 rural FM stations, and vernacular voice talent.
4. Field Logistics, Travel & Workshops • Agrarian cluster community town halls & farmer meetings • Inter-state travel (Oyo, Osun, Ogun, Kaduna trial zones) • Vehicle fueling, rural mobility, field per diems • Extension agent / cooperative leadership briefing days	**$18,000**	**12.0%**	Enables physical monitoring, cluster sensitization meetings with cooperative heads, ground-truthing of soil acidity and Fall Armyworm outbreaks, and safe researcher field mobility.
5. Compliance, Ethics, Auditing & Closeout • Institutional Review Board (IRB) ethical clearance • Independent external financial audits (Year 1 & 2) • National Policy Dissemination Convening (Abuja) • SAM.gov, legal compliance, banking & administration	**$17,000**	**11.3%**	Guarantees bulletproof USAID audit readiness, independent accounting verification, ethical human research compliance, and high-visibility policy dissemination in Abuja with federal ministry leaders.
TOTAL GRANT OPERATING BUDGET	**$150,000**	**100.0%**	**Fully balanced budget satisfying USAID DIV cost-efficiency requirements.**

USAID Compliance, Financial Regulations & Reporting Requirements

Managing US Government funding demands strict adherence to federal regulations (2 CFR 200 and USAID ADS 303). Failure to comply can result in clawbacks, suspension, or debarment.

1. Mandatory Reporting Cycles:

- **Quarterly Progress Reports (QPRs)**: Submitted within 30 days of each fiscal quarter end. Must detail milestone progress, smallholders reached, audio syndication metrics, qualitative challenges, and corrective actions.
- **Quarterly Financial Reports (SF-425)**: Standard federal financial disclosure documenting expenditures against approved budget line items and tracking milestone completion tranches.
- **Annual Performance Reports**: Synthesizes annual agronomic trial progress, preliminary survey insights, and operational refinements.
- **Final Evaluation Report & Data Upload**: Submitted within 90 days of project closeout, accompanied by de-identified raw datasets deposited into the **USAID Development Data Library (DDL)** and public reports published to the **Development Experience Clearinghouse (DEC)**.

2. Strict Financial & Procurement Rules (Allowable vs. Unallowable):

- **Segregated Banking & Timesheets**: All grant transactions must run through the dedicated project account. All personnel charging time must maintain signed, auditable bi-weekly timesheets documenting actual Level of Effort (LOE).
- **Unallowable Costs**: US federal regulations strictly prohibit using grant funds for: luxury goods, alcoholic beverages, entertainment, lobbying government officials, purchasing real estate or unapproved motor vehicles, or paying customs duties/tariffs.

- **Competitive Procurement & Anti-Terrorism Vetting**: Any single service contract or equipment procurement exceeding $10,000 must follow transparent three-quote competitive bidding and undergo mandatory SAM.gov / OFAC sanctions screening.

The Grand Strategy: Transitioning Stage 1 Evidence into a $1,500,000 DIV Stage 2 Award

The ultimate purpose of DIV Stage 1 is not simply to conclude a 2-year project, but to position AgroBiometrix for **DIV Stage 2: Testing and Positioning for Scale ($1,500,000)** or institutional scaling with sovereign ministries. DIV explicitly favors Stage 1 grantees who prove their case.

THE STAGE 2 SCALING BLUEPRINT ($1.5M USD)

What USAID DIV Looks for in Stage 2 Applicants:

1. **Rigorous Causal Evidence:** An econometrically sound Difference-in-Differences evaluation proving that smallholders receiving AgroBiometrix advice increased net farm yields (+8–15%) and certified seed/lime adoption (+20 percentage points) relative to control clusters.
2. **Cost-Effectiveness Superiority:** Empirical proof that AgroBiometrix delivers advisory at ~$0.02 (FM Radio) and ~$0.20 (2G GSM Robocalls), outperforming physical extension ($15–$25 per contact) by orders of magnitude.
3. **Demonstrated Demand Signals:** 10,000+ farmers reached, high broadcast listenership, cooperative willingness-to-pay or government co-financing commitments.

With this evidence in hand by Month 22, you submit the $1.5M Stage 2 application to scale AgroBiometrix across 1,000,000+ farmers across Nigeria, Ghana, and Kenya.

Immediate Practical Checklist for the Principal Investigator

To ensure operational readiness when the award notification arrives, execute the following steps:

1. **Verify SAM.gov / UEI Status**: Confirm that your organization's registration on SAM.gov is active and compliant for federal awards.
2. **Formalize Consortium Sub-Agreements**: Draft preliminary Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) with FUNAAB, OOU, FPI, and UGA clarifying exact roles and LOE.
3. **Draft the IRB Protocol Early**: Prepare the household survey informed consent protocols for expedited FUNAAB ethics review.
4. **Engage Telecom & Radio Partners**: Secure expressions of interest from Africa's Talking and 10 regional community radio stations.
5. **Maintain Technical Documentation**: Preserve the exact mathematical benchmarks, journal manuscripts, and whitepapers we have established.